

can Goldilocks this thing and designate what's too hot, what's too cold, and what's juuuust right.

You will need to engage with all the “too much,” possibly finding what's “too little” in order to eventually land on “enough.”

Since we love gamifying things, we've found various declutter challenges to be effective in helping us to simplify our physical environment. A few of our favorites are:

The 30-Day Declutter: For one month at least one item is intentionally removed from the home each day either via donation, selling, recycling, or trash. For an extra challenge, increase the number of items removed each day (i.e., day 1: declutter one item, day 2: declutter two items, and so on). This intensified strategy will lead to 465 items removed from the home over the course of the month.

The 12-12-12 Challenge: This involves moving through your entire home searching for twelve items to donate, twelve items to put in their proper place, and twelve items that need to be tossed.

The 10 Spaces, 10 Items, 10 Minutes Challenge: This requires only spending ten minutes in one space (room, closet, maybe even just one kitchen cabinet!) and decluttering at least ten items. We like this one because it doesn't need to be accomplished in one sitting! This could be an undertaking over the course of a few weeks.

As we're removing all unnecessary stuff from our spaces, we can also be taking inventory of the type of clutter collectors we are. Similar to looking at our 90-day transaction history, you can look at your things and identify what category most of it falls under. Whether it's aspirational, sentimental, straight-up trash (that you thought was treasure), freebies, or sale items that you never truly needed, too much of a good thing (looking at you, bulk buys and duplicate toys), or “someday I'll have a use for this” odds and ends. Knowing your clutter kryptonites can help you learn more about what you don't value and stop spending on them.

We also want to note that we're not shedding stuff for the sake of minimalism. We're not getting rid of clutter because minimalism is some virtue to attain or to acquire this one version of a minimalist aesthetic but because we want peace in our space and minds. And we want our future spending decisions to be informed. It's possible that we could spend tons of time, energy, and resources maintaining a version of minimalism but sacrifice “simple” in the process. That's why we like to think about